

Chapter 192 - Part 1

Extra 14-1

The day Gu Yixue decided to divorce Shen Fenghe, she only brought a backpack with her.

Even though she'd lived in this house for three years, her luggage was pitifully little.

The divorce agreement was placed at the bedside. She didn't ask for anything, just signed her name and pressed her fingerprint.

The black backpack had been with Gu Yixue for quite some years.

Calculating carefully, this backpack was bought by Shen Fenghe.

Back then, when she was going abroad, she always felt she should see Shen Fenghe one more time before leaving, but couldn't find a reason.

However, that day Shen Fenghe still came to see her off.

Together with Kong Xiaoxiao.

Comparatively, Kong Xiaoxiao was much more enthusiastic.

They were more like elder sisters than Gu Chunmian was, treating her like a neighborhood little sister, buying her some things to check on the plane, telling her to have a smooth journey.

This was the backpack used to pack those things at that time.

It looked quite ordinary, but cost over twenty thousand at the airport shop.

And it was indeed durable.

Gu Yixue had used it for many years.

Even when divorcing, she still used this bag.

Packed inside weren't just belongings, but also her affection and memories.

It wasn't that she didn't love anymore.

Simply... she was tired.

Gu Yixue herself couldn't explain what this feeling was. She just felt that in these three years of marriage, as she and Shen Fenghe grew closer—occasionally drinking together, occasionally talking about everything under the sun, occasionally being uninhibited in their intimacy.

Shen Fenghe didn't say sweet words. Even at the height of passion, she remained the same.

Gu Yixue could move forward at first, walking ahead without caring.

But she never expected that one day she would feel tired.

There wasn't a very clear reason. Her life with Shen Fenghe was the same as usual.

But one night when she came home and saw Gu Chunmian getting out of Shen Fenghe's car, she inexplicably felt exhausted.

Gu Yixue was very clear that Shen Fenghe wasn't someone who would cheat.

Shen Fenghe also looked down on Gu Chunmian.

But that day, she just felt indescribably dejected.

Like a rubber band that had been stretched taut for three years, stretching longer every day. It seemed fine, no problem, but one day, in a completely unguarded moment, it suddenly "snapped" and broke.

Gu Yixue was just like that.

Without a very clear reason.

She just suddenly realized that all of this was merely flowers in a mirror, moon in water.

Without her, Shen Fenghe would still be Shen Fenghe.

Shen Fenghe's life would still be brilliant without Gu Yixue.

And Gu Yixue's life... never mind.

Gu Yixue had never cared.

So Gu Yixue decided to give freedom back to Shen Fenghe.

Before, she'd been stubborn about wanting to have her, always feeling that this person she'd longed for so many years—she could be a dog by her side.

It didn't matter, no problem, she didn't care.

That's what Gu Yixue always told herself.

But truly, one day, when she reached that position, even higher than a dog's status, she would always have some unrealistic fantasies.

For instance, she'll get used to me, right?

She'll fall in love with me, right?

She'll always be good to me, right?

...

This kind of fantasy constantly made her anxious in life.

Gu Yixue felt she was about to go crazy.

Even crazier than before when she hadn't yet become Shen Fenghe's wife.

Before she completely lost it and shocked Shen Fenghe, Gu Yixue decided to leave herself with one last bit of dignity.

So on a calm, sunny day, she put down the divorce agreement and left the villa.

The deaf-mute auntie who took care of their daily life also used sign language to tell her: "Madam, I wish you happiness today and everything goes smoothly."

Gu Yixue gave a very forced smile, then went out the door.

Probably because sadness could give one creative desire, Gu Yixue spent two days writing a new script.

After finishing, she spent another day polishing it, then contacted her team.

And from then on, immersed herself in the production crew.

Chapter 192 - Part 2

Extra 14-2

Shen Fenghe returned home three days later.

She had gone abroad on a business trip to negotiate a very important project.

The process was difficult, but the result was still satisfactory.

At least the negotiation was successful.

Because the project head's daughter was good friends with Gu Chunmian, Shen Fenghe borrowed Gu Chunmian's influence.

But fundamentally, it was Gu Chunmian who came to provoke her first.

The reason was that Gu Chunmian sent her a text message asking to borrow fifty million.

Shen Fenghe's first reaction was whether she'd sent it to the wrong person.

Then Gu Chunmian called her, saying she could exchange a secret about Gu Yixue for these fifty million.

At that time, Gu Yixue was still sleeping. Shen Fenghe tiptoed out of bed to answer the phone, her first words sharp: "Did the Gu family go bankrupt?"

Gu Chunmian: "..."

"Gu Chunmian." Gu Chunmian said: "I'm making a deal with you."

Shen Fenghe was silent for a few seconds.

Gu Chunmian couldn't hold back, saying in a low voice: "Fifty million, I owe you a favor."

"Your favor is worth fifty million?"

"And Gu Yixue's secret."

At that moment, Shen Fenghe looked through the white gauze curtain at Gu Yixue sleeping soundly, her gaze softening somewhat.

Shen Fenghe said coldly: "There are no secrets between me and my wife."

Gu Chunmian: "..."

Having hit a wall, Gu Chunmian was unwilling to give up and continued: "Don't you want to know what Gu Yixue went through after marrying you?"

"She ruined the wedding back then." Gu Chunmian laughed softly, carrying some contempt, "Do you think the Gu family just let her off?"

Shen Fenghe immediately corrected her: "You ruined the wedding."

Gu Chunmian: "...That's not important."

After a pause of a few seconds, Gu Chunmian said again: "Right now I need fifty million. My parents won't give it to me. Shen Fenghe, consider it a loan."

"A loan is a loan." Shen Fenghe said coldly: "What do you mean by 'consider it'? Miss Gu, you're being very ambiguous with your words now."

Gu Chunmian: "..."

It was also later that Shen Fenghe found out Gu Chunmian wanted to break up with that woman.

The fifty million she borrowed was the breakup fee for that woman.

Shen Fenghe scoffed lightly: "She's really thoroughly enjoying being a kept woman."

Gu Chunmian said nothing.

Shen Fenghe had someone transfer the money to Gu Chunmian, but made her write an IOU.

To Shen Fenghe, Gu Chunmian wasn't anyone important.

From a young age, she'd mingled in business circles and dealt with many people, so naturally she wouldn't care about such matters.

Moreover, Gu Chunmian might be the next president of the Gu family.

Perhaps because Mr. Gu had done too many immoral things, aside from Gu Chunmian and Gu Yixue, all the younger generation of the Gu family had either died or been injured—none could shoulder responsibilities.

Compared to Gu Yixue, the Gu family would naturally support Gu Chunmian more.

It was because Gu Chunmian didn't marry into the Shen family that the Gu family became a laughingstock in elite circles, and Mr. Gu could still manage, so he wanted to punish Gu Chunmian.

These past few years, Gu Chunmian had been working at the bottom level of the Gu family company, earning the lowest wages and doing the most work. Her princess syndrome had been worn down quite a bit.

Shen Fenghe had also thought about fighting for the Gu family and giving it to Gu Yixue.

But clearly, Gu Yixue preferred being a director and screenwriter.

And Shen Fenghe quite liked when Gu Yixue filmed. Every time Gu Yixue's work premiered, Shen Fenghe would book out theaters to watch.

Sometimes the latest showing, sometimes the earliest.

Shen Fenghe didn't ask Gu Chunmian what Gu Yixue had paid to marry her.

She felt it would be a very heavy topic.

If Gu Yixue didn't tell her, it proved Gu Yixue didn't want her to know.

She had to give Gu Yixue some personal space.

However, that night Shen Fenghe stood on the balcony for a long time. When she returned to bed, her body was already cool. As soon as she got in bed, Gu Yixue fell into her arms, bringing warmth.

Gu Yixue liked wearing short tops—even her pajamas were short.

There was nothing covering her waist. Shen Fenghe liked to casually rest her hand on her waist.

After Shen Fenghe returned home, she first took a shower, ate the breakfast the auntie made, then went back to her room planning to adjust to the time difference.

Having been gone for nearly a week, she and Gu Yixue hadn't been in much contact.

However, before returning, she'd sent Gu Yixue a message saying she was coming back.

Gu Yixue sent an OK hand gesture and said nothing more.

Shen Fenghe thought she was busy filming, so didn't take it to heart.

Just stared at the screen briefly, feeling a little bit disappointed.

As soon as she got in bed, she saw documents at the bedside. The words "Divorce Agreement" were quite conspicuous.

At first, Shen Fenghe thought it was Gu Yixue's script. But after reading two lines, she suddenly sat up. The drowsiness she'd been building up to adjust to the time difference instantly vanished.

Shen Fenghe read through the script expressionlessly.

Then she picked up her phone to call Gu Yixue, but when she called, she could only hear the cold mechanical voice: The number you have dialed is powered off.

Shen Fenghe got up and changed clothes, having her assistant check Gu Yixue's location.

After a while, the assistant found out Gu Yixue was discussing a collaboration with an investor and had gone to the capital. She'd be back on tonight's flight.

Shen Fenghe sent her a message: [Let's talk.]

Gu Yixue didn't reply.

The message seemed to sink like a stone into the ocean.

Completely different from before.

In the past, Gu Yixue could always reply to Shen Fenghe's messages instantly.

And one reply would be many messages.

If Shen Fenghe's phone vibrated seven or eight times in a row, it was definitely Gu Yixue sending her messages.

It had become a pattern.

But now, Gu Yixue no longer replied to her messages.

Thinking more carefully, it seemed like it had been a long time since she'd received those long strings of messages from Gu Yixue.

Chapter 192 - Part 3

Extra 14-3

Shen Fenghe was about to head out when she received a call from Gu Chunmian, asking her to come to a bar.

Shen Fenghe asked her assistant for information about Gu Yixue's evening flight, then went to the bar to find Gu Chunmian.

When Shen Fenghe arrived, Gu Chunmian had already drunk too much. Her eyes were red as she poured herself drinks while crying.

Shen Fenghe sat a bit farther from her.

Gu Chunmian rambled incoherently, telling her about the breakup, saying she'd originally wanted to find other friends but after scrolling through her contacts, realized Shen Fenghe was her only friend who wasn't quite human.

She must have drunk too much to say such ridiculous things.

Shen Fenghe just sat there looking at her phone, silently listening.

Until Gu Chunmian slammed the table: "Shen Fenghe! Are you even fucking listening to me?!"

Shen Fenghe turned her face, frowning: "Stop going crazy."

Gu Chunmian: "..."

After being speechless for a moment, Gu Chunmian suddenly sniffled and said: "Forget it, I won't argue with you."

Shen Fenghe: "?"

Gu Chunmian suddenly changed the topic: "Back then when Gu Yixue married you, she took my father's whip, over ten lashes."

Shen Fenghe immediately stood up: "What do you mean?"

Gu Chunmian put down her glass, turning her face to look at her: "Literal meaning."

Gu Chunmian also laughed: "I used to think Gu Yixue wasn't worthy of being part of the Gu family, but now I realize she is a Gu family member. We're both stupid as hell."

Gu Chunmian propped her forehead: "We grew up together. I don't like Gu Yixue, and I don't like you either. But... when I'm suffering now, I can only find you. When I feel tired, I frequently think of Gu Yixue. I misjudged someone. Don't let Gu Yixue misjudge too. I wish you two..."

Gu Chunmian raised her glass: "A lifetime together."

As soon as the words fell, Shen Fenghe had already disappeared.

Gu Yixue's flight was at 7:30 PM.

On the way to the airport, she realized her phone was dead and had shut off. She borrowed a power bank from a colleague to charge it.

The battery was too depleted to turn on immediately.

She wasn't in a hurry either, leisurely watching the scenery outside the window.

While waiting at the airport, Gu Yixue finally turned on her phone.

Her colleagues were chatting nearby while she found earbuds to listen to music.

The song playing in her earbuds was:

[Turns out being hypnotized is really interesting

I'm happy to be a dedicated hostage

No time to explain to anyone else

I'm the one holding myself hostage]

Just as she reached the climax, someone pulled out her earbuds.

She thought it was a colleague calling her to board, but when she looked up, it was Shen Fenghe.

Gu Yixue froze for a few seconds, then smiled with difficulty: "What a coincidence."

"Not a coincidence." Shen Fenghe said: "I came specifically to find you."

Gu Yixue pressed her lips together: "What..."

"Do you like me?" Shen Fenghe interrupted her.

She asked very directly and very seriously.

Gu Yixue frowned: "You saw what I left at the bedside, right?"

Shen Fenghe nodded: "Is it sincere? Or is the Gu family forcing you?"

Gu Yixue laughed: "Do you think the Gu family can force me?"

"Using your mother's matters, it's possible." Shen Fenghe said: "After all, your mother is very important to you."

Gu Yixue answered almost without thinking: "Not as important as you."

After saying it, she immediately pressed her lips tight.

Today's Shen Fenghe was very strange, with a serious yet gentle aura.

Like she was very earnestly discussing an issue with Gu Yixue.

But Gu Yixue didn't plan to discuss it with her.

Having already made a decision, further entanglement would be meaningless.

Gu Yixue had decided to let herself go.

So Shen Fenghe asked: "So, you like me?"

Gu Yixue: "..."

Gu Yixue smiled: "I feel like I've said this many times before."

"No." Shen Fenghe said: "You never said it. You were always vague, advancing and retreating, moving forward then backward."

Gu Yixue froze for a moment, then after a while reacted, "So what do you mean by coming now? What do you want to express?"

Shen Fenghe looked at the people coming and going, grabbed her wrist, "Let's go somewhere else to talk."

She pulled her to a secluded place.

But didn't let go of Gu Yixue's wrist.

Gu Yixue lowered her eyes to look, but said nothing.

Shen Fenghe asked again: "Can you answer me very clearly? Do you like me?"

Gu Yixue shook her head: "Not just like."

Gu Yixue wasn't shy. She gave a self-mocking bitter smile: "Sister Fenghe, isn't my love for you obvious enough?"

Shen Fenghe didn't understand: "Then why do you want a divorce?"

Gu Yixue: "..."

No one had told Shen Fenghe these things, and Shen Fenghe really was slow on the uptake.

It was on the way to the capital that Shen Fenghe chatted with Gu Chunmian for a bit, and after staring at the divorce agreement for a long time, that she could reach this conclusion that didn't seem so absurd, though still incredible.

Chapter 192 - Part 4

Extra 14-4

After a long while, Gu Yixue finally said wearily: "I'm tired. I don't want to wonder anxiously whether you might possibly love me, and I don't want to think about whether you're fulfilling obligations or seeking emotional needs when we're intimate."

Gu Yixue looked at her, calling her name solemnly for the first time: "Shen Fenghe, let's just leave it at this."

Shen Fenghe frowned: "Didn't you marry me to spite the Gu family? To spite Gu Chunmian?"

Gu Yixue: "..."

Gu Yixue was so angry she didn't want to speak.

But as she turned to leave, Shen Fenghe grabbed her hand, saying: "Don't get divorced."

Gu Yixue's footsteps halted, her throat dry: "Why?"

Shen Fenghe stood in place for a long time. When the airport announcement sounded, she finally said: "I seem to... love you a little."

Gu Yixue was shocked, turning to frown at her: "A little?"

Shen Fenghe moved closer to her, placing her hand over her own heart: "Feel it."

Gu Yixue's palm could feel her heartbeat, racing rapidly with thumping sounds.

"When you said those things just now, my heart rate accelerated." Shen Fenghe said seriously: "Also, when I saw the divorce agreement at home... I cried."

Gu Yixue: "?"

Shen Fenghe was a bit embarrassed too, but didn't hide her emotions.

She'd analyzed it the entire way on the plane using very rational methods, but found no results.

Finally, it was the assistant beside her who couldn't help but remind her that she must care about Gu Yixue very much.

Shen Fenghe herself didn't understand, asking why.

The assistant: "..."

The assistant said every time Gu Yixue had a new film, she would book out theaters—not just for company employees, but she'd go watch it herself, and would be very happy after watching.

The assistant also said that whenever she encountered something pretty, she'd always think about wrapping it up for Gu Yixue.

Even on this business trip abroad, when time was very tight, just because she saw a platinum necklace in a jewelry store window from the car that would suit Gu Yixue well, she specifically got out of the car to buy it, and was even late for her meeting with the partners because of it.

This was the first time in seven years of employment that the assistant had seen Shen Fenghe be late.

After the assistant listed everything, she couldn't help but complain: If this isn't love!

And Shen Fenghe thought of that suffocating feeling when she saw the divorce agreement, and the tears that inexplicably fell from her eyes.

Though incredible and hard to accept that she was capable of love.

But... in the end, she still tentatively spoke her thoughts.

Shen Fenghe never liked to hide things, especially when it came to emotions.

Gu Yixue asked: "Why only 'a little'?"

Shen Fenghe: "Because I'm not certain."

Gu Yixue: "Then wait until you're certain before coming."

Shen Fenghe: "...I have to date you first before I can be certain."

Shen Fenghe's tone was stiff, and she was gripping Gu Yixue's wrist so tightly it hurt.

Those light brown eyes were very serious.

Gu Yixue suddenly smiled and without warning leaned close to her, kissing her directly on the lips.

Shen Fenghe's pupils dilated, stunned in place, but her hands instinctively wrapped around her waist, holding tight.

When Gu Yixue released her, both their breathing was somewhat rapid, yet she still asked: "Did your heart race just now?"

Shen Fenghe directly grabbed her hand and placed it over her heart, "Feel it."

Gu Yixue: "..."

Yes, beating very fast.

Gu Yixue stared straight at her, smiling: "Were you serious about what you just said?"

"Which sentence?" Shen Fenghe asked back.

Gu Yixue said: "The one about dating."

Shen Fenghe nodded: "We have to try to know."

Gu Yixue's lips curved upward, and those long, narrow fox eyes lifted, appearing full of charm: "Then... let's try dating."

Before, she always thought wind belonged to spring.

Later she discovered that actually wind and snow were the best match.